Tavy Bridge news

GALLIONS HOUSING ASSOCIATION



EDITION FOUR JANUARY 2003







october november december



Drama workshop

A second Drama workshop was held during the autumn school break, once again it proved very successful. The children had great fun, learning to sing, dance and act. If you are interested in joining the Drama group contact Claire Wythe at **Theatre Street** on 020 8317 8950.

Black History Month

Thamesmead Youth Awareness Program (TYAP) held their First Black History month celebration event this year between 17th and 19th October at the Emmanuel's Church Hall.

It started off on Thursday 17th October with performances by UMOJA, a South African Performance Group currently appearing in the West End.

Various local organisations were present, including The Black Commission for Racial Equality, The Metropolitan Police, and Connexions, who gave valuable information on careers, job opportunities and where to seek further advice. Belvedere Jive Dance School put on a wonderful production of The History of Jive: Parkway Primary and St John Fisher schools also enjoyed the day.

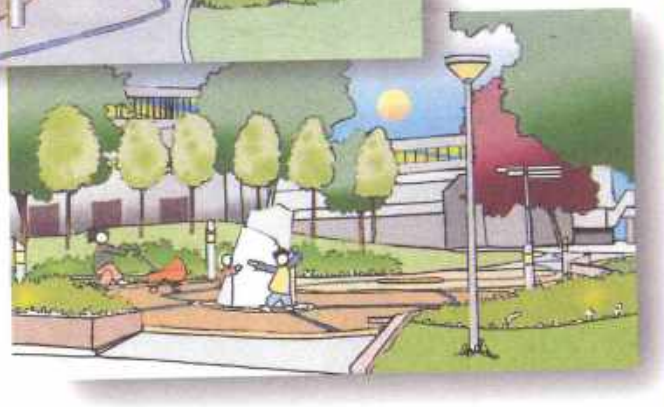
An informative workshop was facilitated by Black People in Britain which highlighted the contributions of various cultures to the community we live in today.

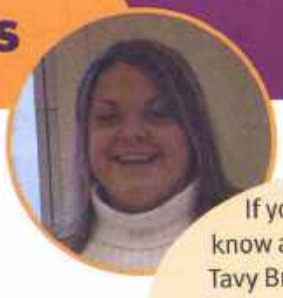
The Gala night on Saturday 19th was a day for local young people to take control of the stage, with singing, poetry and dance. The local talent of young people was both impressive and entertaining, and enjoyed by all.

YAP intend to run a yearly black history month and plan to make the 2003 event bigger and brighter for the community. If you are interested in becoming involved in the next **Black History Month** or would just like to be kept up to date please contact Norma on 020 8311 5111.

Tavy Bridge improvement works







If you would like to know anything about the Tavy Bridge Regeneration scheme please contact me on **020 8320 3480** or email me: dwithall@gallionsha.co.uk

Hello! My name is Debbie Withall and I am the Project Co-ordinator for the Tavy Bridge Regeneration scheme. I will be working with Claire Irvine for the next nine months and will be helping to plan and consult with residents and organisations.

I have been working in the Community Renewal and Development departments of Gallions Housing Association for the past ten months and am looking forward to ensuring that the plans for Tavy Bridge become a reality.

Now that the new year is here, work will begin to improve the green area behind Tavy Bridge next to the lake. Improvements will be made to the following:

- Lighting
- Seating
- Paving
- Fencing
- New litterbins and a natural boulder feature will also be installed.

A company called T. Loughman and Co. will be carrying out the work, which has already started and is due to last for six weeks.

We have worked with the Tavy Bridge Focus Group to develop this project – we will be using it to test out some of the materials and features we hope to use in the larger scale improvements to the area.

Let us know what you think!

This is the second part of the project to improve safety and security at Tavy Bridge. We have received lots of positive reports about the CCTV cameras and the cameras have helped the police to identify individuals who are causing problems at Tavy Bridge. All this work has been funded by the Woolwich Development Agency SRB Programme and Gallions Housing Association.

Don't forget that if you witness a crime or anti social behaviour, you can give us a call and we will check the cameras.

Meanwhile, we are continuing to work on proposals for the wider regeneration of Tavy Bridge and Binsey Walk. In early Spring, we hope to show you some possible proposals to get your feedback. If you want to speak to someone about the project, please contact Claire Irvine on 020 8320 3494. Claire will also be working closely with the Tavy and Binsey Tenants and Residents Association.



Claire Irvine

If you have any queries about these improvement works, either now or when the work starts, or you would like to see the plans, please contact the Gallions Customer Response Centre on 0800 83 84 81.

New PC on the beat...



Tim Massey will be working in Thamesmead with PC Rob Evans for ten weeks as part of his probationary duties. He is approachable, has a good sense of humour and gets on well with people of all ages and backgrounds.

Tim is a welcomed extra resource for the Bexley part of Thamesmead and you should see him on and around Tavy Bridge over the next ten weeks. When he moves on to his next placement, another probationary officer will come to work with PC Rob Evans.

Police Appeal

Please keep your eyes peeled for suspicious cars and people around the secure garage areas. Recently, a stolen car of high value was found in these garages and was involved in serious crimes.

If you see any cars which you believe to be suspicious please contact the police. You don't have to give your name. Just because people are in the secure area it doesn't mean they have a lawful right to be there.

PC Rob Evans would like to say a big THANK YOU for the vigilance of local people.

Audio X



The new and exciting **Audio X** music technology project is now up & running, launched with Trust Thamesmead and Gallions Housing Association, to deliver music training for young people in the Thamesmead and Abbey Wood areas. Part of the project is a 12 week LOCN (London Open College Network) accredited course using the latest music production software, which is open to 15 – 25 year olds.

We are also open as a drop in facility to 12 – 25 year olds.

The project aims to provide quality music training in a supported environment. We are based at T.Y.A.P. which is part of the Gallions Housing Association offices.

Call the Audio X team for details on:
020 8311 5111

Gallions Community Audit

Gallions Housing Association has commissioned a regeneration consultant – Renaisi, to carry out a social research project about the needs, concerns, priorities and aspirations of local residents and agencies in Thamesmead. This research will help Gallions to develop its Community Renewal Strategy.

The project will give to Gallions:

- A breakdown of facts and figures for the Thameamead area.
- A database of community and voluntary groups.
- A collection of views of residents through: introductory brochure and reply slip, sample questionnaire survey, a stall at the Housing Fayre, Focus groups and the Thamesmead Vision Day.
- Interviews with key organisations in Thamesmead.

A summary of the community audit results will be available by the end of February. For more information please contact Sam Weaver on 0208 320 3418.



Southmere Lake update



Well Done!!!

The hard work of some dedicated residents has paid off. After taking the advice of local bird enthusiast Pat Hawley, pictured left, we have installed some pontoons for the water birds of Southmere Lake to nest in. Hopefully next year we will see a rise in the bird population – keep watching.

Thamesmead Vision Day

A total of 70 people attended the Thamesmead Vision Day at Woolwich Polytechnic on 23rd October.

The Vision Day provided an opportunity for local people to share their many and varied experiences, views and ideas for the future of Thamesmead's rich and vibrant community. Local service providers and other key organisations were there to listen and contribute.

Thamesmead Library

The refurbishment of the children's library is almost complete. The library has been freshened up with a new coat of paint, new shelving has been installed and 14 new computers have been delivered.

The new computers will provide free Internet access, scanning facilities and the opportunity to print either in black and white or colour although there will be a charge for printing.

The Mayor of Bexley, Ann Lucas, will attend an opening ceremony on 8th February at 2.30pm.

• Places are still available for the Basic Skills Learning class held on Wednesdays at the library. Please contact the library for further infomation about how to apply.

To find out more, phone 020 8310 9944 and have a chat to the friendly staff at the library.

Community Planting Days

As part of our Trees for Thamesmead strategy we are planning, in partnership with Groundwork, two Community Planting Days on Friday 31st January and Saturday 1st February 2003. We are looking for local volunteers to help us dig and plant. If you are interested please contact Kaye Sene on **020 8320 3462.**



The Community Chest

Do you need a small pot of money for a local initiative?

Then apply to the Gallions Community Chest! We are here to offer help to local residents and groups who have an initiative they would like to run.

For example we can help you buy books and toys for playgroups or nurseries, support local youth activities, help with set up costs for a garden tools library, or improve local areas with additional flower beds. If you have an existing project or an idea for a project and would like some financial help, please contact Kaye Sene on **020 8320 3462.**

What sort of groups get support?

Here are some the project we have helped.

- Four Legged Friends
- The Monday Club
- Thamesmead United Football Club
- Abbey Primary School
- Theatre Streets Drama School
- Black History Month organised by The Youth Awareness Project

So why not apply now!

This newsletter is produced by Gallions Housing Association.